Robby Bridges

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Software developer with leadership experience passionate about using AI to engineer delightful software. Five years at SAS across Java microservices, React front ends, and LLM-accelerated development.

EXPERIENCE

SAS Institute Inc. 2021 – Present
Software Developer 2026 – Present
Senior Associate Software Developer 2024 – 2026
Associate Software Developer 2023 – 2024
Software Developer Intern 2021 – 2022

Lead Developer, SAS Viya 4 Migration App (React / TypeScript)

- Led a team of 8–10 developers to redesign and rebuild a web app used by nearly every customer migrating to SAS Viya 4.
- Represented the development team in product management and UX engagements; broke designs into independently developable and testable user stories and ran the team's Agile process.
- Shipped in 7 months against a 9-month estimate by moving one feature to the next release; kept delivering new features in later releases, with overwhelmingly positive user feedback.
- Set API standards, owned complex and high-traffic areas of the codebase, and coordinated with the microservice lead on parallel backend changes.
- Grew a team that started with only two React developers through one-on-one pairing and team workshops.

Backend Development (Java / Go)

- Helped re-architect a critical part of the migration orchestration Java microservice, a legacy codebase with 40+ authors, without breaking API contracts or customers.
- Rewriting the service in Go; work day-to-day with Docker, Kubernetes, and CI/CD pipelines.

AI / LLM Initiatives

- Built a data analytics agent proof of concept in one week on a self-hosted Gemma 4 30B model, with tools to inspect CSV files, query them with model-generated SQL, and search documentation via vector search (RAG).
- Developed with the Strands SDK and hosted with Docker and Traefik on GPU; the concept is now being developed by an adjacent team.

Infrastructure

- Developed workflows to automate regular dependency upgrades and hotfixes

Mentorship

- Mentored every summer intern and several new hires since joining full time; one former intern has become the team's onboarding liaison and has been promoted to Senior Associate.
- Wrote onboarding docs and procedures that cut new-teammate ramp-up from weeks to days.

Speaking

- Co-led a GitHub Copilot keynote workshop on stage alongside GitHub representatives, walking the audience from basic coding-agent use to complex agentic engineering with live examples.
- Presented at R&D user groups on helping coding agents verify their own work, including browser tools and Playwright MCP for front-end changes.
- Demoed the data analytics agent proof of concept in internal presentations.

SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, React, Java, Go, Python

Infrastructure: Git, Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Workflows/Actions, CI/CD

AI: Coding Agents (GitHub Copilot/Claude Code/Codex), LLM agents (Strands SDK), RAG and vector search, hosting LLMs on GPUs (Ollama)

EDUCATION

North Carolina State University Fall 2022 (Go Pack!)

B.S. Computer Science, *summa cum laude*

- Senior project: led a team building a computer vision application for landfill waste classification, in partnership with IBM.

VOLUNTEERING

- Providence Church: Discipled high school students and served as their camp counselor for three summers.
- CRU NCSU: Volunteered as a Bible study leader.